# Shoulder Mini -DBQ (Disability Benefits Questionnaire)

**Please answer the following questions regarding the current severity of your Service-Connected Shoulder:**
**What caused the condition (injury etc)?**

**How long have you had this problem?**

**Do you experience shoulder flare-ups?** ☐ Yes ☐ No
If yes what do you think causes the flare -ups?

**Describe In your own words: Today, how does your Shoulder condition your daily life and Range of Motion i.e. can you perform basic movements (standing, walking, lifting, sitting etc)?**

**Does this affect your work? How?**

**Are you right-handed or left-handed?**

☐ Right-Handed ☐ Left-Handed ☐ Ambidextrous

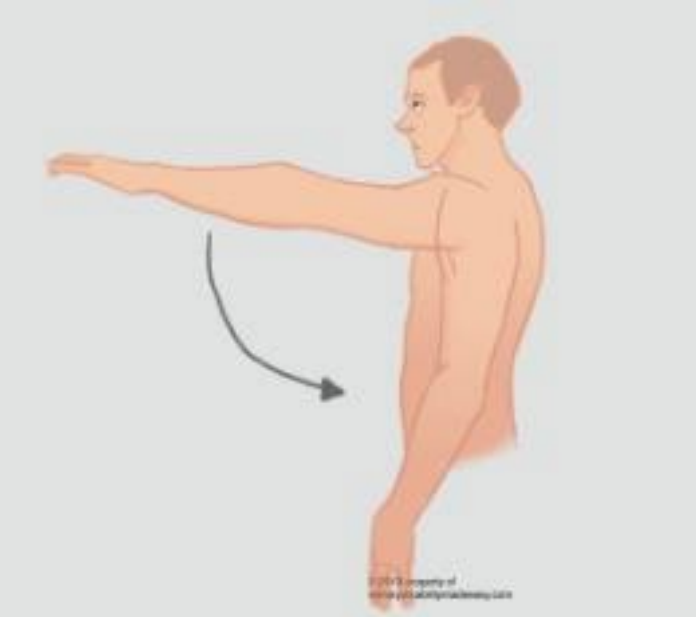
**Which Shoulder is Service Connected?**

☐ Right Shoulder ☐ Left Shoulder ☐ Both Shoulders

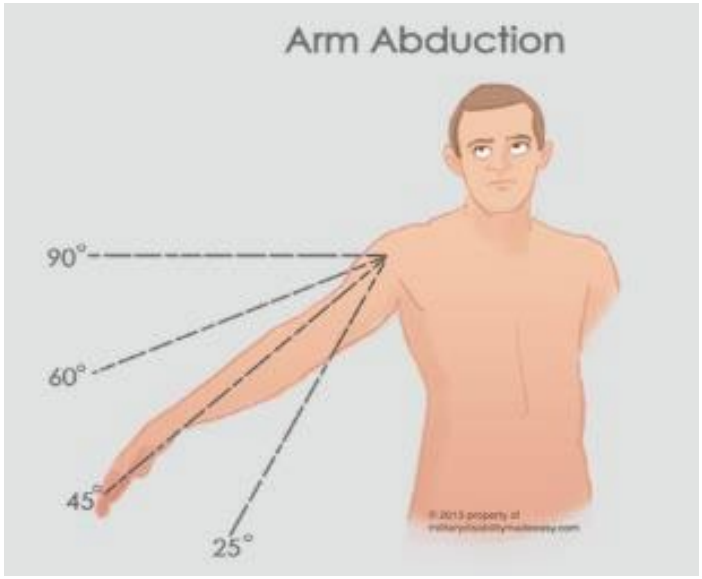
# Shoulder Mini -DBQ (Disability Benefits Questionnaire)

**RANGE OF MOTION: THIS DETERMINES YOUR DISABILITY RATING**

| **RANGE OF MOTION FOR SHOULDER/S - Flexion**<br>Begin by standing. Put your arm out straight to your side. Keep arm straight and lift your arm up as high as you can in front of you as shown in picture to the right. | |
|---|---|
| **LEFT** | **RIGHT** |
| To which degree can you lift your arm? (180 degrees is full range of motion) | To which degree can you lift your arm? (180 degrees is full range of motion) |
| **Flare-Ups: Think about when your back is HURTING. This number should be LESS than the one above!** | |
| **LEFT SHOULDER** | **RIGHT SHOULDER** |
| To which degree can you lift your arm? (180 degrees is full range of motion) | To which degree can you lift your arm? (180 degrees is full range of motion) |



| **RANGE OF MOTION FOR SHOULDER/S - Abduction**<br>Begin by standing. Put your arm out straight to your side. Keep arm straight and lift your arm up as high as you can in front of you as shown in picture to the right. | |
|---|---|
| **LEFT** | **RIGHT** |
| To which degree can you lift your arm? (180 degrees is full range of motion) | To which degree can you lift your arm? (180 degrees is full range of motion) |
| **Flare-Ups: Think about when your back is HURTING. This number should be LESS than the one above!** | |
| **LEFT SHOULDER** | **RIGHT SHOULDER** |
| To which degree can you lift your arm? (180 degrees is full range of motion) | To which degree can you lift your arm? (180 degrees is full range of motion) |

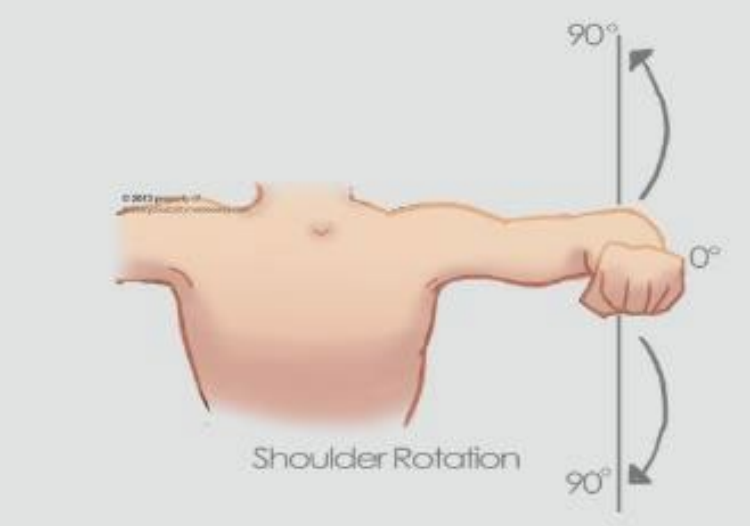


**RANGE OF MOTION FOR SHOULDER/S – External and Internal Rotation**
Begin by standing. Lock your elbows in a 90-degree angle and twist your arm up as high as you can. Then Twist your arm down to the ground as low as you can. Repeat with other shoulder.

| External | | Internal | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **LEFT SHOULDER** | **RIGHT SHOULDER** | **LEFT SHOULDER** | **RIGHT SHOULDER** |
| To which degree can you rotate your arm up? (90 degrees is full range of motion) | To which degree can you rotate your arm up? (90 degrees is full range of motion) | To which degree can you rotate your arm down? (90 degrees is full range of motion) | To which degree can you rotate your arm down? (90 degrees is full range of motion) |

**Flare-Ups: Think about when your back is HURTING. This number should be LESS than the one above!**

| External | | Internal | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **LEFT SHOULDER** | RIGHT SHOULDER | **LEFT SHOULDER** | RIGHT SHOULDER |
| To which degree can you rotate your arm up? (90 degrees is full range of motion) | To which degree can you rotate your arm down? (90 degrees is full range of motion) | To which degree can you rotate your arm up? (90 degrees is full range of motion) | To which degree can you rotate your arm down? (90 degrees is full range of motion) |




***(Please answer questions on next page related to these movements)***

**Are these movements painful?** ☐ Yes ☐ No

**If yes then specify,**

**Are these movements painful when repeated (at least 3 times)?** ☐ Yes ☐ No

**If yes, then specify which shoulder?**

☐ Right Shoulder ☐ Left Shoulder ☐ Both Shoulders

**Do you pain when lifting weights?** ☐ Yes ☐ No

***If yes specify*:**

**CHECK THE CONTRIBUTING FACTORS AFFECTING THE FUNCTIONALITY OF YOUR SHOULDER/S:**

☐ Incoordination *(impaired ability to execute skilled movements smoothly*)

☐ Swelling *(tenderness) (If marked please specify if there is pain on touching the swelling)*:

☐ Weakened Movement (feeling weakness in muscles) ☐ Pain on Movement

☐ Easily Fatigued Less movement than normal ☐ Atrophy of disuse (decreased muscle mass)

☐ Disturbance in movements Interferes with sitting Interferes with standing

**VERY IMPORTANT: History of Shoulder Surgery – Provide type of surgery, indicate if VA did surgery or private doctor, and date:**

**Do you take any medications for this condition? (e.g. painkillers, muscle relaxants etc) If yes list all the medications.**

**Do you perform any exercise for this condition or undergo physiotherapy?**

**SHOULDER INSTABILITY AND/OR DISLOCATIONS**

**Do you ever experience dislocations and/or instability *(joint comes out of socket, movement is weakened)*?**

☐ Yes, a few times a year
☐ Right Shoulder ☐ Left Shoulder ☐ Both Shoulders

☐ Yes – Frequently, at least once a month
☐ Right Shoulder ☐ Left Shoulder ☐ Both Shoulders

☐ No, I do not have experience instability or dislocations.

*Additional Information*

**CERTIFICATION - To the best of my knowledge, the information contained herein is accurate, complete and current. I understand that overstating the severity of my conditions on official Disability Benefits Questionnaires (DBQs) could result in loss of benefits and/or be consider fraudulent. I am conveying the severity of my symptoms to the best of my ability on this personal assessment form. No one has advised me to misrepresent my conditions or overstate the severity of my symptoms.**